



MONTHLY UPDATE

Gulf/UAE activities: monthly update, August 2026

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BOTSWANA · GAMBIA · KENYA · SOUTH SUDAN · ZIMBABWE

Botswana

The heads of agreement behind the data centre are unchanged, and the [operator's quarterly account of 3 August does not name the counterparty](#). It remains the only source of its kind the base holds for Botswana at any date.

Gambia

Gulf involvement is now on the record in two forms, neither carrying a figure. The Islamic Development Bank's own sector page records it [financing the regional fibre backbone reaching The Gambia alongside two other lenders, with no date or sum given](#), and a Bahraini firm's [January memorandum with the regulator offers a free critical-infrastructure security tier with no value or duration stated](#).

Kenya

Kenya and Qatar [agreed on 12 August to institutionalise annual bilateral political consultations](#), the inaugural round led on the Kenyan side at principal secretary level. The account names no digital instrument, no committed amount and no project. That is the shape of the Gulf record here generally: seven memoranda signed with the United Arab Emirates in May 2025 and diaspora consultations in Riyadh in July 2026, none of them describing what was agreed in terms this base can put on a system or an instrument.

South Sudan

The legislature [ratified the general cooperation agreement with Saudi Arabia](#) on 19 August, three months after rejecting it on sovereignty grounds. The agreement, signed in 2022, covers agriculture, education, mining, infrastructure, health, trade, investment, security and social development. No digital or data commitment appears in it.

Zimbabwe

The Emirati minister of state [met the President in Harare on 10 August to discuss economy, investment and trade](#). No agreement was announced, which is the movement: the two governments had [agreed in Dubai in February to conclude a comprehensive economic partnership agreement within three months](#), and August is three months past that deadline.

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